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To Whom it May Concern,

It is not often I get to work with a highly conscientious, creative, and capable engineer. It is essentially unfathomable such an engineer would be an intern still in school; Thomas has proved himself to be that enigma of an intern. When Thomas interviewed with me, I only allocated an hour, but very quickly I realized I needed to clear out my schedule and we spent over two hours discussing his capabilities and problem solving. Like a game of chess, I would pose a hypothetical and he would think through the solution set and counter with an idea. I was so impressed with his interview that I canceled all my other appointments and offered him the job on the spot. He was obviously in the 99th percentile of interns and I would have been impressed if he were coming on as a junior engineer.

During that interview I laid out a dream project that I have had no luck getting completed throughout the years: an automatic induction soldering manufacturing cell. I explained to him that I honestly believed he would fail, I simply didn't have the time to babysit and hold his hand and if he couldn't get any traction on the project, I was going to have to relegate him to documentation and assistant work. I believe he may have taken it personally; because in his first two weeks of working on it, he made more progress than any intern or group of interns had made in over a month. I can only explain his vicious attack on the project akin to a starving feral dog finding its first meal in weeks. He jumped from manual lathe to mill to 3D printer to CNC mill, designed all of his own CAD models familiarized himself with purchasing and sourcing parts, took full advantage of McMaster Carr's free 3D models, created the PLC program, wired the control panel, found sensors to position the conveyors, learned how to do serial communications to servo drives and ended up putting all these pieces together to designing the complex manufacturing cell. The only correction I ever had to issue was telling him to stop, go home, you can't clock out and keep working because you're going to mess up our insurance.

Through that whole process he never asked the same question twice and never asked a stupid question. I was in pure awe seeing this come together from whiteboard sketches to CAD to physical parts to moving contraption he himself machined and assembled.

My role in this project was simply being the bowling alley bumpers. Id walk by the machine shop, and Thomas would ask for some design help. Id just bounce him back on center by showing him how to remove an operation or setup from a part, maybe make it a bit stronger, help him find something off the shelf rather than custom. Eventually he would ask more complex questions that stumped me for a moment; I would bring up a potential solution and he'd respond, "Yeah I thought about that but if we do that then this won't work, here is everything I could come up with what do you think?" All I could think is "WOW!" I have trouble getting those results out of seasoned engineers sometimes! Throughout his four-month internship I spent maybe upwards of 20-30 hours helping Thomas. It turns out those bumpers did not get much use and instead he bowled strike after strike on his own.

I believe Thomas would be an indispensable component to your organization. He will undoubtedly take on any task with fervor and tenacity. Just make sure whatever you give him you have something else waiting for him next, because I don't think he can stop himself from working.

With best regards,

Guillermo M. Rodriguez